

To see what Aristotle is thinking, let's look at two propositions about a possible future free action of yours.

The law of the excluded middle

For any proposition P , either P is true or Not- P is true.

So it must be that, if the law of the excluded middle is true, then one of these claims is true, and one of them is false.

But to endorse this is just to believe in fate, since it is to say that there is now a truth about whether you will get married on that day.

A second argument for the reality of fate is based, not on logic alone, but on certain widely held views about God.

You will not get married
on June 1, 2027.

You will get married on
June 1, 2027.

It is widely held that God is omniscient, and also widely held that
(for this reason) God knows what actions you will perform in the
future.

But if God knows what actions you will perform in the future, there must be truths about what actions you will perform in the future (otherwise there would be nothing for God to know).

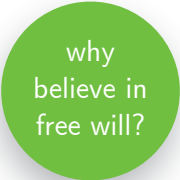
We can put this together into the following argument for fate.



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

To see what Aristotle is thinking, let's look at two

propositions about possible future free action of yours.



For any proposition P , either P is true or Not- P

The Law of the Land

indivisible.

of these claims is true, and one of them is false.

So it must be that, if the law of the excluded middle is true, then

day.

there is no truth about whether you will get married or that

But to endorse this is just to believe in fate, since it is to say that

alone, but on certain widely held views about God.

A second argument for the reality of fate is based, not on logic

It is widely held that God is omniscient, and also widely held that

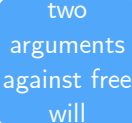
(for this reason) God knows what actions you will perform in the

future.

future (otherwise there would be nothing for God to know).

But if God knows what actions you will perform in the future,

there must be truths about what actions you will perform in the



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

responding to Edwards' argument. But

argument might be related to an argument

first let's think about how Edwards'

for fatalsn.

We'll shortly consider some ways of

Suppose that someone did not believe in

there were truths about all our future

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

actions. Could they give an argument

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

similar to Edwards' argument?

our future actions.

with reference to the being of truth about

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

God only shows up in premises (2) and

replace reference to God's foreknowledge





will perform various actions.

1. We have no direct facts.

God knows that in the future I will

3 We have not at the fact that

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

2* In the past, there were truths about

5* We have noticed that the fact

perform a certain action (1,2)

that if it is true that I will perform

acaioid.

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

then we have the choice about q.

all of our activities.

(3, 4, 5)

some action, then I will prefer that

0 We have achieved what we

The fatalist argument

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

either.

things as fate, then there is no free will.

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

serious challenge to the reality of free will?

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

freedom that comes from fate.

A second argument for the reality of fate is based, not on logic

alone, but on certain widely held views about God.

It is widely held that God is omniscient, and also widely held that

future.

(for this reason) God knows what actions you will perform in the

But if God knows what actions you will perform in the future,

there must be truth about what actions you will perform in the

future (otherwise there would be nothing for God to know).

We can put this together into the theological argument for fate.